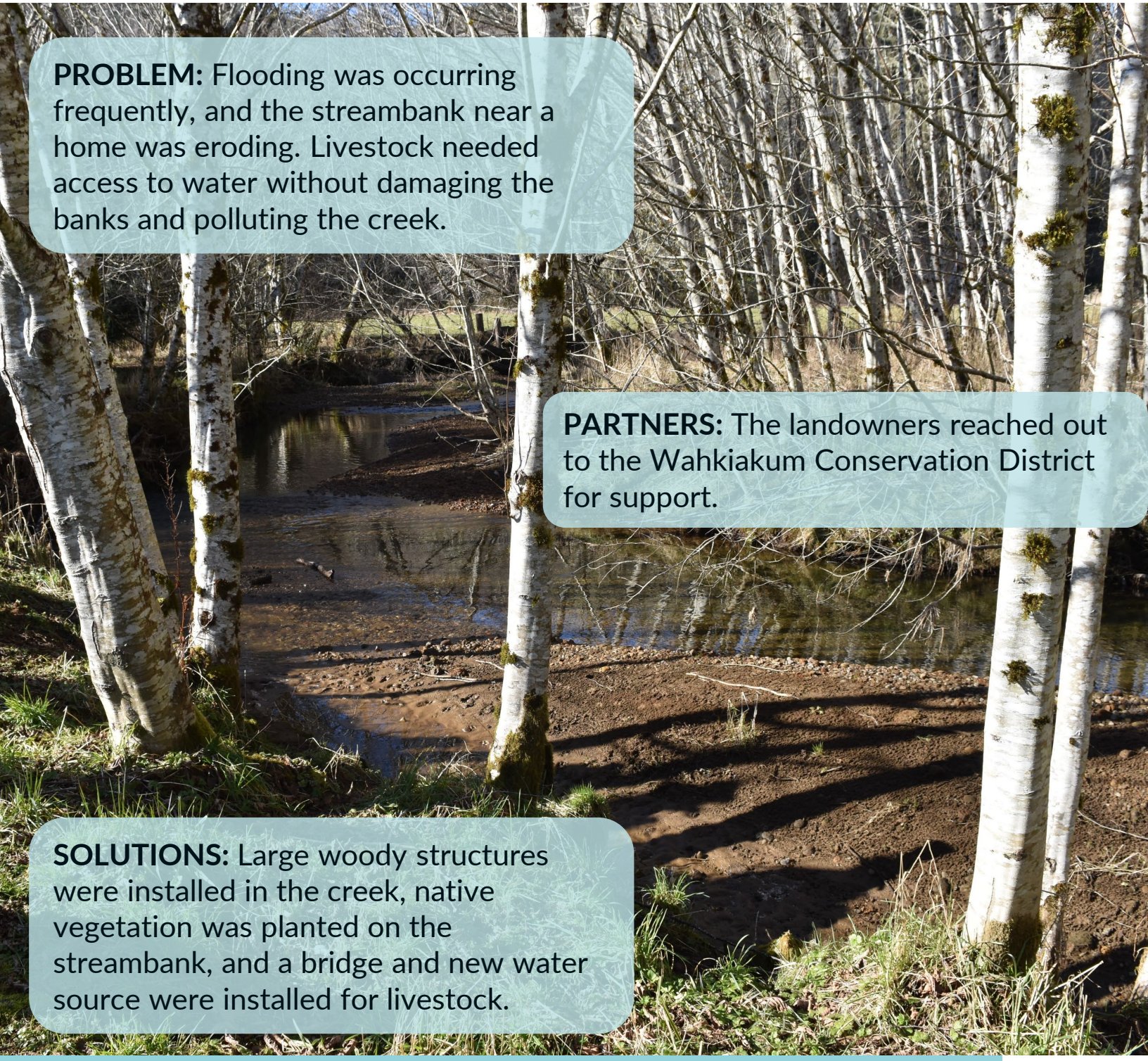
WAHKIAKUM COMMON GROUND

Success Story: Skamokawa Creek

The home and bed & breakfast of Wahkiakum County residents was at risk due to erosion and flooding. By collaborating with local, state, and federal agencies, they were able to protect their property and improve stream conditions for fish.



PROBLEM: Flooding was occurring frequently, and the streambank near a home was eroding. Livestock needed access to water without damaging the banks and polluting the creek.

PARTNERS: The landowners reached out to the Wahkiakum Conservation District for support.

SOLUTIONS: Large woody structures were installed in the creek, native vegetation was planted on the streambank, and a bridge and new water source were installed for livestock.

Want to know more? Visit https://beav.es/WCG

Wahkiakum County MRC

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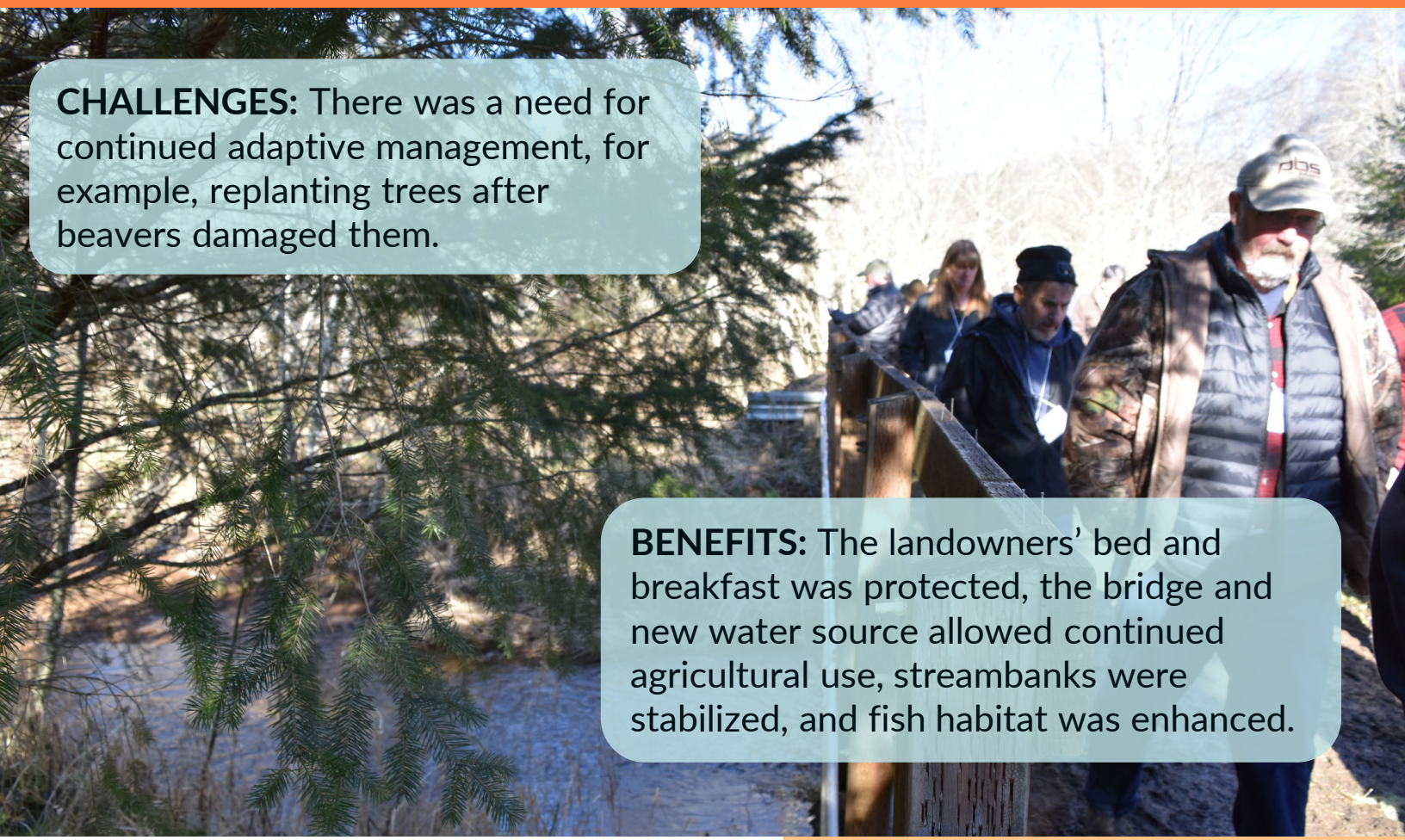

CHALLENGES: There was a need for continued adaptive management, for example, replanting trees after beavers damaged them.

BENEFITS: The landowners' bed and breakfast was protected, the bridge and new water source allowed continued agricultural use, streambanks were stabilized, and fish habitat was enhanced.

LESSONS LEARNED

Stream systems are dynamic and require ongoing adaptation. This project is an example of total resource management, designed to protect the bed and breakfast from severe erosion, to improve stream conditions for fish, and restrict stream access by livestock.

PROJECT PARTNERS & FUNDERS

Private Landowners
Wahkiakum Conservation District
Conservation Reserve Program (USDA)
Army Corps of Engineers
WA Department of Fish and Wildlife

***Wahkiakum County** relies on a healthy salmon fishery for commercial, tribal, and recreational purposes, yet salmon populations are threatened. Efforts to support sustainable fisheries by restoring watersheds also have benefits for the community: reducing risk from coastal hazards, boosting economic vitality, and improving emergency preparedness.*

To learn about multi-benefit watershed restoration **SUCCESS STORIES** in Wahkiakum County or to **get involved** visit:

https://beav.es/WCG